



THE RAMAYANA OF VALMIKI

Bala Kanda

A Children's Illustrated Storybook · 42 Pages

BOOK ONE · THE BOOK OF CHILDHOOD

An original simplified retelling for children,
with detailed AI illustration prompts.

Based on the translation by Hari Prasad Shastri.

How to Use This Book

Each page has two parts:

- **Story Text for Kids** — 2–4 simple, magical sentences to read aloud.
- **AI Image Prompt** — a richly detailed prompt written for a **polished digital children's-book illustration** look, kept visually consistent from page to page, **full-bleed with no borders**.

For best results, paste the **Master Style Block** (below) together with each page's prompt, or simply use each prompt as-is — the art-style and character notes are already woven into every one.

Master Style Block (for visual consistency)

Medium & style: Richly detailed **digital children's-storybook illustration**, in the style of a modern Illustrated Ramayana for Children cover — **semi-realistic yet softly stylized** characters with expressive friendly faces, large warm eyes and smooth skin; polished **digital painting** with gentle **cel-shading**, soft airbrushed gradients and crisp clean highlights; finely detailed traditional Indian costumes, fabrics and jewelry; **lush painterly backgrounds** with atmospheric depth and soft focus.

Lighting: warm **cinematic** directional light with a gentle glowing rim-light and soft ambient glow.

Colour: vibrant, saturated, harmonious — saffron, marigold gold, turquoise, rose-magenta, leaf green and deep indigo.

Skin tones: Only **Rama** (and, where they appear, divine forms of **Vishnu** and **Shiva**) has gentle **blue/teal skin**; **every other character has a natural human skin tone** — warm golden-brown, fair or tawny — and is **never blue**. Vanaras (monkey-people) keep natural fur colours.

Costume: strictly **ancient, traditional Indian attire** — dhotis, angavastrams, draped saris, mukut crowns and traditional gold jewelry, bark-cloth and deerskin for forest-exiles, classical robes and armour — with **absolutely no modern clothing, fabrics, footwear or accessories**.

Composition: dynamic, **full-bleed, edge-to-edge, absolutely no border and no frame**. Aspect ratio 4:3 (use portrait 3:4 for a cover).

Character Reference Sheet (keep consistent on every page)

- **Rama** — gentle prince, soft **blue/teal skin**, large kind eyes, calm half-smile; golden-yellow silk *dhoti*, jeweled gold crown (*mukut*), pearl-and-emerald necklaces, golden armlets; carries a bow. Eldest, serene, radiating quiet warmth.
- **Lakshmana** — fair golden-brown skin, alert and devoted; saffron-orange *dhoti*, simpler gold ornaments; always at Rama's side.
- **Sita** — radiant golden-brown complexion, soft expressive eyes, jasmine flowers in long dark braid; red-and-gold *sari*, delicate gold jewelry (*maang tikka*, bangles, nose-ring). Graceful and gentle.
- **Vishwamitra** — tall elderly sage, long white beard, matted top-knot, weathered kind-but-intense eyes; ochre-saffron robes, *rudraksha* bead strings, tall wooden staff.
- **Dasaratha** — aged noble king, grey beard, gentle tired eyes; cream-and-gold royal robes, tall jeweled crown.
- **Janaka** — wise silver-bearded king of Mithila, serene smile, elegant white-and-gold robes with pearl strands.

Page 1: The Question of the Perfect Hero

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Long ago, the gentle sage Valmiki wondered, "Who is the bravest, kindest, most truthful person in all the world?" The heavenly singer Narada smiled and said, "There is one such soul — a prince named Rama." And so a beautiful story began.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tranquil forest hermitage at soft golden dawn beside a glassy, mist-curling river. In the foreground sits the elderly sage **Valmiki** cross-legged on a woven deerskin mat — long flowing white beard, ochre robe over one shoulder, *rudraksha* beads, gazing upward with wide, wonder-filled eyes and one hand raised in a question. Floating just above on a luminous pink lotus-cloud is the celestial sage **Narada**, a youthful radiant figure in white-and-gold silk, a peacock-feather tuft, holding a glowing golden *veena* (lute), encircled by a soft halo and drifting silver stars. Surroundings: towering banyan trees with hanging roots, a blooming lotus pond, a curious peacock with fanned tail, fireflies, slanting dawn sunbeams through the leaves. Emotions: serene curiosity and gentle wisdom. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive friendly faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft airbrushed gradients, detailed costumes and jewelry, lush atmospheric background with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 2: The Sorrowful Bird and the First Poem

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Beside the river Tamasa, Valmiki saw a hunter harm a little singing bird called a krauncha, and his heart filled with sorrow. His sadness flowed out as the very first poem ever sung! Then Lord Brahma appeared in a shower of light and blessed him: "Tell Rama's whole story in song, and the world will love it forever."

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A reedy riverbank in tender morning light. **Valmiki** stands with one hand pressed to his heart and the other lifted, tears glistening in his compassionate eyes, watching a pair of graceful **krauncha cranes** among the rushes — one fluttering protectively over its mate. Descending from the heavens on an enormous pale-pink lotus is four-faced **Lord Brahma**, golden-skinned, serene, in white-and-saffron silks with a long white beard, holding a manuscript and water-pot, one palm extended in blessing; shimmering golden light-ribbons of verse ripple outward. Surroundings: tall green reeds, floating lotus pads, soft river mist, distant herons, gentle sun-haze. Emotions: deep tender sorrow turning to sacred wonder. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed fabrics, lush atmospheric background with soft focus, warm cinematic light with glowing rim-light; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-rose-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 3: The Golden City of Ayodhya

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Far away stood Ayodhya, a city so beautiful it sparkled like a jewel. Its kind and mighty ruler, King Dasaratha, cared for every person as if they were his own family. Banners waved, bells rang, and everyone lived happily.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A sweeping panoramic view of the magnificent ancient city of **Ayodhya** at sunrise. Tiers of golden domed palaces, carved sandstone *jharokha* balconies, fluttering saffron-and-crimson banners, temple spires catching first light, lotus-filled reflecting ponds. Wide clean streets bustle with cheerful citizens in bright clothing, garland-sellers, a caparisoned elephant in embroidered cloth, children flying kites. In the foreground on a high balcony stands aged **King Dasaratha** — grey beard, kind tired eyes, cream-and-gold robes, tall jeweled crown — smiling warmly and waving, marigold garlands on the railing. Emotions: pride, warmth, belonging. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized look, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, ornate detailed architecture and costumes, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic sunrise light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 4: The King's Quiet Wish

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Though King Dasaratha had everything, his heart held one quiet sadness — he had no children to fill his palace with laughter. Each evening he gazed at the empty halls and softly wished for a son. A good king, he knew, must hope and be patient.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A vast, hushed royal hall at dusk, washed in violet-and-amber lamplight. **King Dasaratha** sits alone upon an ornately carved jeweled throne beneath a silk canopy, leaning forward with his chin resting on one hand, a soft wistful sorrow in his gentle eyes, gazing toward a small empty cradle-seat draped in untouched silk across the room. Tall fluted pillars with peacock and lotus carvings recede into soft shadow; a single brass oil-lamp glows warmly; long evening light slants through arched windows revealing a quiet courtyard beyond. Emotions: tender longing, patient melancholy, quiet dignity. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized character, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft moody gradients, detailed throne and fabrics, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic lamplight with gentle rim-glow; rich muted colours (saffron-indigo-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 5: The Wise Sage Rishyasringa

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

The king's faithful minister Sumantra had an idea: "Invite the holy young sage Rishyasringa! Wherever he goes, blessings follow." So with great respect, the gentle sage was welcomed to Ayodhya to help the king's wish come true.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A joyful welcome at the grand flower-draped palace gateway of Ayodhya. The young sage **Rishyasringa** arrives in simple saffron robes with a soft golden halo, deer-gentle eyes and a serene smile, a small antelope walking trustingly at his side. **King Dasaratha** and his wise minister **Sumantra** bow low with folded hands and delighted faces; women in colourful saris scatter rose petals and wave brass lamps, while drummers and a conch-blower celebrate. Surroundings: archways woven with mango leaves and marigolds, *rangoli* on the ground, fluttering banners, lush palace gardens. Emotions: reverence, hope, festive warmth. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed costumes and decorations, lush atmospheric background with soft focus, warm cinematic light with

rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-marigold-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 6: The Great Fire Sacrifice

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

A grand sacred ceremony began on the banks of the river Sarayu. Priests chanted, sweet smoke curled into the sky, and golden flames danced in the holy fire. Everyone prayed with hopeful hearts for the king to be blessed with sons.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A majestic open-air **fire-sacrifice (yajna)** on a wide riverbank at dawn. A large square golden-brick altar holds tall, gracefully curling flames; rows of sages in white-and-saffron robes sit cross-legged pouring ghee offerings from carved ladles, eyes peacefully closed, lips parted in chant. **King Dasaratha** kneels reverently at the front with folded hands and a hopeful upturned face; the young sage **Rishyasringa** presides, raising a blessing. Sacred smoke spirals into a pink-gold sky; brass pots, heaped garlands, banana-leaf offerings and *kalash* pots surround the altar; the river shimmers behind. Emotions: devotion, hope, sacred stillness. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, glowing fire with soft gradients, detailed ritual objects, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic dawn light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-gold-turquoise). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 7: A Plea in the Heavens

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

High in the heavens, the gods were worried about a cruel ten-headed demon-king named Ravana, who frightened everyone. Together they flew to Lord Vishnu and begged, "Only you can save the world from him!"

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A vast celestial cloud-realm of swirling pastel skies, drifting lotus blooms and distant galaxies. A gathering of luminous **gods** with folded hands and worried, pleading faces — **Indra** on his white four-tusked elephant Airavata, plus shining haloed deities — float before **Lord Vishnu**, who reclines serenely upon the great coiled white serpent **Shesha** atop a cosmic milky ocean: blue-skinned, calm, crowned, four arms holding conch, discus, mace and lotus, a gentle knowing smile. Far below in a brooding storm-corner looms the dark shadowy silhouette of ten-headed **Ravana** with twenty glinting eyes, ringed by lightning. Emotions: divine worry above, serene reassurance at center, distant menace below. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized divine characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, glowing soft gradients, detailed ornaments, dreamy atmospheric depth with soft focus, cinematic celestial lighting with luminous rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (turquoise-saffron-indigo-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 8: Vishnu's Great Promise

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Lord Vishnu smiled kindly and made a great promise: "I will be born on Earth as a human prince, and I will set everything right." The gods rejoiced, for they knew goodness would soon walk among people.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A radiant heavenly close view of **Lord Vishnu**, blue-skinned and majestic, sitting upright on his coiled serpent throne, golden crown and *vaijayanti* garland, one hand raised in the *abhaya* (fear-not) gesture; a soft golden beam of light flows from his heart down toward a tiny, glowing blue-green **Earth** cradled in the clouds below. Around the edges, grateful gods (Indra, the wind-god, the fire-god, celestial nymphs) bow with relieved, joyful faces, palms together. Drifting lotus petals, shimmering star-dust, concentric rings of light. Emotions: serene compassion and collective relief. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized divine figures, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous soft gradients and god-rays, detailed jewelry, atmospheric depth with soft focus, cinematic glowing light with strong rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (turquoise-saffron-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 9: The Gift from the Sacred Fire

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

As the ceremony reached its peak, a glowing divine being rose from the flames, holding a golden bowl of magical sweet pudding. "Share this with your queens," he said. The king's heart leapt with joy, for his wish was about to come true!

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A dramatic, joyful miracle at the fire altar. From tall curling golden flames rises a majestic **celestial messenger** — broad, glowing, dark-complexioned, draped in red-and-gold silk with a jeweled crown and a radiant aura — holding out with both hands a gleaming golden bowl of sacred **payasam** (sweet rice pudding) that sparkles with light. **King Dasaratha** kneels close, receiving it with wide, overjoyed, tear-bright eyes and trembling folded hands. Sages around the altar gasp in awe, hands raised; sparks and embers float upward, smoke swirls, garlands frame the scene. Emotions: astonishment, overflowing joy, sacred wonder. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, glowing fire and soft gradients, detailed silk and jewelry, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic firelight with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-crimson-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 10: Four Princes Are Born

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Soon the palace rang with happy cries — four baby princes were born! Queen Kaushalya's son was named Rama, Queen Kaikeyi's son was Bharata, and Queen Sumitra had two sons, Lakshmana and Shatrughna. All of Ayodhya celebrated, and the king's quiet sadness turned into the greatest joy.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A warm, glowing palace nursery bathed in soft golden lamplight. Three radiant **queen-mothers** (Kaushalya, Kaikeyi, Sumitra) in jewel-toned silk saris and fine gold jewelry tenderly cradle four glowing newborn **princes** wrapped in soft silks — baby **Rama** at the center with a delicate blue tint, a tiny gold crown and anklets, a soft halo; the other babies gurgle happily. **King Dasaratha** leans in with joyful tears and a beaming smile. Silk-draped cradles, hanging flower garlands, rows of brass lamps, a celebration glimpsed through arched windows with festive light. Emotions: overflowing love, tenderness, jubilation. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with warm expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft glowing gradients, detailed saris and jewelry, cozy atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic lamplight with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-rose-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 11: Brave Princes and Hidden Helpers

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

The four brothers grew up strong, clever, and kind, learning archery, the scriptures, and how to care for others. Rama, the eldest, loved everyone the most. And far away in the forests, mighty monkey-heroes — among them Vali, Sugriva, and the wise Hanuman — were quietly being born, secret friends Rama would need one day.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A bright split-scene composition with a soft natural divider of foliage (no hard line). **Left:** a sunny palace courtyard where the four young **princes** practice archery under a wise turbaned teacher — Rama (soft blue skin, focused gentle smile, golden dhoti) drawing a glowing bow at a straw target, his three brothers cheering with bows in hand; peacocks, flowering trees, fluttering banners. **Right:** a lush emerald forest where playful golden-and-russet **vanara (monkey) children** with bright eyes leap among ancient trees and waterfalls, faint sparkles of divine light haloing them. Emotions: youthful joy, discipline, playful wonder, gentle destiny. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed costumes and fur, lush atmospheric background with soft focus, warm cinematic light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-leaf-green-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 12: The Sage's Important Request

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

One day the powerful sage Vishwamitra strode into the palace. "Demons are spoiling our holy prayers in the forest," he said. "Please send young Rama to protect us." Everyone was surprised — Rama was still so young!

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A grand pillared throne room lit by warm lamplight. The tall elderly sage **Vishwamitra** strides forward commandingly — long white beard, matted top-knot, ochre robes, *rudraksha* beads, wooden staff, intense determined eyes — one arm extended in earnest request toward the throne. **King Dasaratha** sits upon his jeweled throne looking startled and torn; courtiers and ministers murmur with surprised faces. Young **Rama** and **Lakshmana** stand respectfully to the side with calm, curious expressions. Surroundings: carved peacock-and-lotus pillars, a royal silk canopy, hanging brass lamps, patterned marble floor, guards with spears. Emotions: urgency, surprise, quiet readiness. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed architecture and robes, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic lamplight with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-amber-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 13: A Father's Worry, A Wise Word

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

The king's heart trembled to send his dear son away. But the royal teacher Vasishtha said gently, "Trust the sage. Rama is destined for greatness." So Rama and his loyal brother Lakshmana set out, bows in hand, ready and brave.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tender farewell at a sunlit palace doorway in golden-hour light. **King Dasaratha** gently rests a hand on **Rama's** shoulder, his face a mix of worry and trust, eyes glistening; beside him the serene white-robed royal preceptor **Vasishtha** — long silver beard, calm reassuring smile — nods wisely with a raised blessing hand. **Rama** (blue tint, brave gentle smile, golden dhoti) and **Lakshmana** (saffron dhoti) stand poised with bows and quivers, one foot stepping toward an open carved gateway that frames a glowing sunlit path. Garlands, a brass threshold lamp, a waiting attendant. Emotions: bittersweet love, trust, brave resolve. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft warm gradients, detailed robes and jewelry, atmospheric depth with soft focus, golden-hour cinematic light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-gold-rose). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 14: Secret Chants by the River

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

As they walked beside the shining river Sarayu, Vishwamitra taught the princes two magical chants called Bala and Atibala. These gifts kept them strong, never tired, and never afraid. The boys listened carefully, for learning is its own kind of power.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A serene riverside path beside the sparkling **Sarayu** at warm late-morning. **Vishwamitra** walks slightly ahead, half-turned, mid-teaching with an expressive raised hand; faint glowing golden symbols and soft ripples of light shimmer in the air around the trio as the sacred chants are spoken. **Rama** and **Lakshmana** follow close behind with attentive, respectful faces and folded hands. Surroundings: a winding earthen path, swaying tall reeds and lotus blooms, herons wading, dragonflies, gentle green hills, sun-dappled trees, the silver river curving into the distance. Emotions: focus, reverence, peaceful learning. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, glowing magic symbols, lush atmospheric landscape with soft focus, warm cinematic light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (turquoise-saffron-green-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 15: The Dark Forest of Taraka

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Soon they reached a gloomy, tangled forest where no birds sang. A fierce demoness named Taraka had frightened everyone away. "Be brave," said the sage. "This forest can be peaceful again."

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A mysterious, shadowy forest of twisted bare trees, gnarled roots and swirling violet mist, with faint eerie glowing eyes peeking from the darkness (kept gentle and kid-friendly, not frightening). **Rama** and **Lakshmana** stand alert at the forest's edge in a shaft of hopeful light, bows half-raised, brave and watchful expressions; **Vishwamitra** points firmly into the gloom, his face calm and resolute. Deep among distant trees looms the large shadowy silhouette of the demoness **Taraka**, suggested rather than detailed. Surroundings: tangled vines, glowing toadstools, drifting fog, a broken moonlit path, bats wheeling far off. Emotions: suspense, courage, steady resolve. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized heroes, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, moody soft gradients, atmospheric misty depth with soft focus, dramatic cinematic lighting with a warm rim-glow on the heroes; rich saturated colours (deep indigo-teal-saffron). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 16: Rama Brings Back the Light

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Taraka rushed out with a terrible roar, but Rama stood calm and steady. With one swift, brave arrow, he freed the forest from her fear. At once, sunlight poured in, birds returned, and the trees seemed to smile again.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A dynamic, hopeful action moment. Young **Rama** (soft blue skin, calm focused face, golden dhoti, hair flowing) stands firm with legs braced, releasing a brilliant **glowing golden arrow** from his deeply bent bow; the dark violet mist dramatically dissolves into swirling sparkles of light, and the looming demoness-shadow scatters harmlessly into glowing wisps. **Lakshmana** stands proudly behind, bow ready. All around, warm sunbeams burst through newly leafy emerald trees, colourful birds and butterflies return, flowers bloom, a clear stream sparkles. Emotions: serene courage, triumph, renewal. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized hero, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous soft gradients, glowing energy effects, lush atmospheric background transitioning dark-to-bright with soft focus, cinematic light with strong rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-emerald-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 17: Gifts of the Shining Weapons

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Pleased with Rama's courage, Vishwamitra gave him wondrous celestial weapons that glowed with divine light. They appeared as friendly shining beings, ready to help only when truly needed. Rama promised to use them wisely, never for showing off.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A magical, reverent twilight clearing in the forest. **Vishwamitra** stands with both arms raised, eyes glowing with wisdom, as a swirling spiral of luminous **celestial weapons (divya astras)** materialise as gentle shining spirit-figures and shimmering radiant arrows of coloured light, descending gracefully toward **Rama**, who kneels humbly with folded hands, head slightly bowed, a soft serene glow on his face. **Lakshmana** watches in quiet awe nearby. Surroundings: a deep-blue starry sky, fireflies, glowing floating mandala patterns and lotus-light in the air, ancient trees framing the clearing. Emotions: humility, awe, sacred trust. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous glowing soft gradients and light-spirits, detailed robes, mystical atmospheric depth with soft focus, cinematic night lighting with radiant rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (turquoise-violet-saffron-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 18: Guarding the Holy Prayers

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

At Vishwamitra's hermitage, the gentle sages began their sacred fire-prayer. Rama and Lakshmana stood guard for many days, watchful and brave. Suddenly the sky darkened — the demons Maricha and Subahu came swooping down to spoil everything!

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A forest hermitage with a glowing golden fire-altar where peaceful sages sit chanting in a ring, eyes closed. In the foreground,

Rama and **Lakshmana** stand alert on guard, bows raised toward a suddenly **darkening, storm-churned sky** where two fierce flying demons — **Maricha** and **Subahu**, wild-haired, fanged, trailing dark smoke and hurling shadows and stones toward the altar — come swooping down. The princes' faces are determined and protective. Surroundings: thatched hermitage huts, sacred *tulsi* plants, scattered offerings, wind-whipped trees, ash and embers swirling. Emotions: tension, vigilance, brave defiance. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized heroes and stylized demons (not gory), polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, dramatic soft gradients, glowing firelight against stormy dark, atmospheric depth with soft focus, cinematic lighting with warm rim-glow on the princes; rich saturated colours (saffron firelight vs deep storm-indigo). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 19: The Sacrifice Is Saved

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Quick as lightning, Rama fitted a special arrow to his bow. With one gentle, powerful shot he flung the demon Maricha far across the ocean, and stopped the others. The sacred fire blazed on, and the grateful sages blessed the brave young prince.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A triumphant action scene bursting with light. **Rama** (calm and radiant, glowing with quiet power, golden dhoti, hair streaming) releases a brilliant beam-like **manava-astra** arrow; across the scene, the demon **Maricha** tumbles head-over-heels far away toward a distant shining blue **ocean** on the horizon, comically harmless, while the dark storm clouds split open to reveal warm golden sky. The fire-altar blazes safe and bright; joyful **sages** rise with hands lifted in blessing toward **Rama** and **Lakshmana**, beaming with gratitude. Drifting flower petals, returning sunlight, sparkles. Emotions: relief, victory, gratitude. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous soft gradients, dynamic glowing energy and motion, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, cinematic light breaking through storm with strong rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 20: A Journey and a Wonderful Tale

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Next, Vishwamitra led the princes toward the city of Mithila for a great celebration. As they walked, he told them a magical story: "Let me tell you how the holy river Ganga came down to Earth." The boys leaned in, eager to listen.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A scenic travelling scene along a winding path over rolling emerald hills in warm afternoon light. **Vishwamitra** walks ahead with his staff, animatedly mid-story with an expressive sweeping gesture; **Rama** and **Lakshmana** follow close, leaning in with curious, delighted faces. Above them, a soft dreamy **story-cloud** begins to form, hinting at a shimmering blue river-goddess flowing through the heavens. Surroundings: wildflower meadows, grazing deer, distant temple spires and a faint city skyline (Mithila) on the horizon, butterflies, a winding silver stream, soft cumulus clouds. Emotions: wonder, eagerness, gentle camaraderie. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, dreamy glowing story-cloud, lush atmospheric landscape with soft focus, warm cinematic light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-leaf-green-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 21: King Sagara and the Sacred Horse

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

"Long ago," said the sage, "the mighty King Sagara held a grand ceremony with a beautiful sacred horse. But sneaky trouble was near — the horse suddenly vanished without a trace!" The king's sixty thousand sons set off to search the whole world.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A legendary flashback scene glowing with a soft golden light (no hard frame — blended vignette of warm haze). The proud ancient **King Sagara** in regal crimson-and-gold robes and a tall crown stands by an ornate fire-altar, arm outstretched in dismay as a magnificent **white sacred horse**, adorned with gold ornaments and a jeweled bridle, rears up and begins to dissolve into a trail of magical sparkles, vanishing. In the mid-distance, a vast energetic army of his **many sons** sets off in all directions across the land, banners high. Surroundings: a grand palace, billowing flags, a dramatic golden sky, dust of departure. Emotions: alarm, determination, epic scale. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, glowing vanishing-sparkle effect, grand atmospheric depth with soft focus, dramatic cinematic golden light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-crimson-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame;** aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 22: A Mistake and a Lesson

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Digging deep into the earth, the sons finally found the horse beside the silent, glowing sage Kapila. Without asking, they shouted at him angrily — and in a flash of heat, they were turned to ashes. It was a sad lesson: never be rude to the wise and the kind.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A deep cavernous underground hollow lit by a soft inner golden glow. The serene meditating sage **Kapila** sits radiantly cross-legged with closed eyes and a faint halo, the recovered **white sacred horse** grazing calmly beside him. Around him, several of King Sagara's **sons** stand with angry pointing gestures and shouting faces — and from the sage's gentle aura a warm burst of light begins to softly transform them into glowing drifting ash-sparkles (rendered tenderly and symbolically, not scary). Surroundings: glittering mineral cavern walls, roots threading from above, a still subterranean pool reflecting the glow. Emotions: serene calm versus reckless anger; a quiet moral hush. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, warm glowing soft gradients, detailed cavern textures, atmospheric depth with soft focus, dramatic cinematic inner-glow lighting with rim-light; rich saturated colours (amber-gold-umber). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame;** aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 23: Bhagiratha's Mighty Effort

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Years later, the noble prince Bhagiratha wished to free his ancestors' souls. He prayed with all his heart for the holy river Ganga to flow down from the heavens. He stood still for a very long time, showing that patience and devotion can move even the gods.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A breathtaking high Himalayan peak at first dawn. The noble prince **Bhagiratha** stands alone in deep penance atop a snow-dusted crag — one leg raised in the classic ascetic pose, palms joined overhead, eyes peacefully closed, a soft glow of unwavering devotion around him; frost on his shoulders, tiny sparrows perched on his arms, his hair and simple robe rimed with snow. Surroundings: vast misty blue mountain ranges fading into rose-gold sunrise, drifting clouds, a faint shimmering **river-of-stars** winding through the heavens above, hinting at Ganga waiting to descend. Emotions: serene determination, patience, sacred longing. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized figure, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft luminous gradients, detailed snow and frost, vast atmospheric mountain depth with soft focus, serene cinematic dawn light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (turquoise-rose-gold-white). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 24: The River Falls from Heaven

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

At last the mighty Ganga came rushing down from the sky! But she was so powerful she might have flooded the whole Earth — so kind Lord Shiva caught her gently in his tangled hair and let her flow softly. Following Bhagiratha, the holy river freed his ancestors and blessed the land.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A spectacular, joyful cosmic waterfall scene. The radiant blue **river-goddess Ganga**, graceful and crowned with foam and lotuses, cascades down from the starry heavens as a glittering torrent of water and light. Seated calmly below on a great Himalayan crag is **Lord Shiva** — serene, ash-pale-blue skin, blue throat, crescent moon in his flowing matted locks, half-closed meditative eyes, a tiger-skin wrap and *rudraksha* beads — his tangled hair gently catching and taming the mighty river into soft branching streams. Below, **Prince Bhagiratha** leads the gentled river along a glowing winding path across the green land. Surroundings: rainbow spray, lotus blooms, soft light-rays, distant peaks. Emotions: awe, divine grace, gratitude, relief. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized divine figures, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous flowing water and soft gradients, detailed ornaments, grand atmospheric depth with soft focus, cinematic divine lighting with strong rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (turquoise-saffron-white-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 25: The Churning of the Ocean

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Vishwamitra shared another wonder: long ago, the gods and demons churned the great Milky Ocean together, using Mount Mandara as the churning-stick and the giant serpent Vasuki as the rope. Out came amazing treasures and amrita, the precious nectar of life. It showed that even rivals can create something good by working together.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

An epic, colourful cosmic tableau of the **Samudra Manthana (churning of the milky ocean)**. At the center, the great **Mount Mandara** stands as a churning rod, wrapped around its middle by the enormous serpent **Vasuki**; a long row of glowing **gods (devas)** in golden ornaments pull the tail on one side while a row of strong horned **demons (asuras)** pull the head on the other, leaning back in a grand cosmic tug-of-war. Beneath the mountain, **Lord Vishnu as the giant turtle Kurma** steadies the base. Rising from the swirling white foam: a radiant white elephant, a wish-cow, lotuses, jewels, and a luminous golden pot of **amrita (nectar)**. Surroundings: a vast frothing milky sea, dramatic sky, rainbow spray, scattered stars. Emotions: epic

teamwork, wonder, cosmic energy. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, dynamic glowing soft gradients, detailed ornaments and treasures, sweeping atmospheric depth with soft focus, dramatic cinematic lighting with luminous rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (turquoise-saffron-magenta-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 26: The Hermitage and the Quiet Stone

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Their path led to the peaceful, empty hermitage of the sage Gautama, where a strange grey stone lay among the flowers. "This was once Ahalya, the noble wife of Sage Gautama," said Vishwamitra softly. "Long ago she was turned to stone, waiting for the touch of someone truly good."

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A quiet, overgrown forest hermitage bathed in soft green-gold dappled light. Among blooming wild vines, ferns and fallen leaves rests a smooth grey **stone faintly shaped like a serene woman's reclining form**, gentle and dignified. **Rama, Lakshmana** and **Vishwamitra** approach softly and respectfully along a mossy path; the sage gestures toward the stone with a tender, knowing expression, telling its story. Surroundings: a still reflecting pond with lotuses, the abandoned thatched hut of Sage Gautama reclaimed by nature, slanting sun-shafts through tall trees, butterflies, a sense of patient, hopeful waiting. Emotions: gentle reverence, compassion, quiet mystery. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft dappled gradients, detailed foliage and stone, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic forest light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (moss-green-gold-rose). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 27: Ahalya Is Freed

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

As Rama's gentle foot touched the stone, a warm light spread through it. The stone softened, and kind Ahalya stood up alive once more, smiling with happy tears! Rama's goodness and forgiveness had set her free.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A magical, warm transformation scene. Where the grey stone lay, a graceful woman, **Ahalya**, in flowing pale-rose-and-cream robes with simple gold jewelry, rises gently upward from a soft burst of golden light, palms joined in gratitude, joyful tears shining on her serene face, a halo of renewal around her. **Rama** (blue tint, compassionate gentle smile) stands close, his foot having just touched the spot, radiating warm light; **Lakshmana** watches with tender wonder and **Vishwamitra** blesses the moment with a raised hand. Surroundings: flowers suddenly bloom open, petals swirl upward, the pond sparkles, soft sunrays pour through the trees. Emotions: redemption, joy, compassion, awe. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous golden soft gradients, detailed robes and flowers, atmospheric depth with soft focus, radiant cinematic light with strong rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-rose-gold-green). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 28: Welcome to Mithila

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

At last they reached the festive city of Mithila, ruled by the wise and gentle King Janaka. He welcomed Vishwamitra and the two princes with great warmth and curiosity. "Who are these shining young heroes?" he wondered with a smile.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A joyful arrival at the beautifully decorated ancient city of **Mithila**. The wise silver-bearded **King Janaka** in elegant white-and-gold robes with pearl strands steps forward with folded hands and a delighted, curious smile to greet **Vishwamitra**, **Rama** and **Lakshmana** at a grand flower-draped stone gateway. Surroundings: festive crowds in bright clothing, musicians with drums and conch, dancers, women waving lamps and scattering petals, mango-leaf and marigold *toran* archways, colourful *rangoli* on the ground, fluttering flags, temple spires and palace domes glowing in bright midday sun. Emotions: warm welcome, curiosity, celebration. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, ornate detailed architecture and costumes, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, bright cinematic daylight with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-turquoise-magenta-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 29: The Earth-Child and the Mighty Bow

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

King Janaka told a wonderful story: "My daughter Sita was found in a furrow of the earth, a gift from the land itself." Then he showed them a giant, ancient bow of Lord Shiva, so heavy that no king alive could even lift it. "Whoever bends this bow," he said, "shall marry my brave Sita."

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A grand royal hall of Mithila. Kind **King Janaka** gestures with quiet pride toward an enormous, ornate ancient **bow of Shiva** resting on a great gilded wheeled cart, faintly glowing with divine blue power, almost too big for the room. In a soft glowing **memory-vision** above (blended in warm haze, no hard frame), a tiny radiant baby girl (**Sita**) is shown nestled in a golden furrow of a freshly plowed field, light beaming around her. The grown **Sita** (golden-brown complexion, jasmine in her braid, red-and-gold sari, delicate gold *maang tikka* and bangles) stands gracefully nearby with shy, lowered eyes. **Rama**, **Lakshmana** and **Vishwamitra** gaze in wonder. Surroundings: carved pillars, hanging brass lamps, garlands, courtiers. Emotions: pride, wonder, gentle anticipation, shy hope. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft glowing gradients, detailed architecture and the great bow, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic hall lighting with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 30: Rama Lifts the Unliftable Bow

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Calmly, Rama walked up to the enormous bow. To everyone's amazement, he lifted it as easily as a flower — and as he bent it to string it, the great bow snapped with a sound like thunder! The whole hall gasped, then burst into cheers.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A spectacular, awe-filled climax in the great hall. Young **Rama** (serene, softly glowing, golden dhoti) effortlessly bends the colossal divine **bow of Shiva** into a deep arc — and it cracks in a brilliant flash of blue-white light with radiating shockwave rings rippling outward. **King Janaka, Sita, Vishwamitra** and the assembled crowd react with wide-eyed astonishment turning to overjoyed cheering, hands flung up. Flower petals rain down, golden sparks fly, dramatic light-beams pierce the hall. Emotions: astonishment, triumph, exhilaration, destiny fulfilled. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, dynamic luminous soft gradients, glowing energy burst and shockwave, detailed crowd and hall, atmospheric depth with soft focus, dramatic cinematic light with strong rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-turquoise-gold-white). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 31: Sita Chooses Rama

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Gentle Sita stepped forward and placed a beautiful flower garland around Rama's neck, choosing him as her husband. The people of Mithila cheered with delight, and swift messengers raced to Ayodhya to share the wonderful news. Love and goodness had found each other.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tender, joyful ceremony. Radiant **Sita** (golden-brown complexion, jasmine in her long braid, red-and-gold bridal sari, fine gold jewelry, soft blush) gracefully lifts a large fragrant **flower garland (jaimala)** over smiling **Rama's** head; both share shy, happy, downcast glances. A delighted crowd showers flower petals and waves lamps; musicians celebrate. In a small inset corner (softly blended, not framed), **messengers** on swift horses gallop down a road toward distant Ayodhya. Surroundings: a decorated marriage pavilion, garland arches, glowing lamps, golden petals filling the air. Emotions: shy love, joy, blessing, new beginnings. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft warm gradients, detailed bridal costumes and jewelry, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (magenta-saffron-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 32: The King Journeys to Mithila

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

When the happy news reached Ayodhya, King Dasaratha was overjoyed! He set out for Mithila with his other sons, his ministers, and a grand royal parade. The roads filled with elephants, music, and the sound of celebration.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A magnificent royal procession winding across the sunny countryside. Aged **King Dasaratha** rides a richly caparisoned **elephant** beneath a golden parasol, beaming with joyful pride; behind him march princes **Bharata** and **Shatrughna** on horseback, ministers, banner-bearers, drummers, conch-blowers, and ranks of soldiers with colourful pennants. Garlands and bunting line the route; villagers wave, dance and offer flowers; children run alongside. Surroundings: rolling green fields, blossoming trees, distant Mithila's spires on the horizon, a bright blue sky with soft clouds, festive golden dust. Emotions: jubilation, fatherly pride, festive excitement. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters and elephants, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed royal regalia, lush atmospheric landscape with soft focus, bright cinematic daylight with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-turquoise-green-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**;

aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 33: Four Brothers, Four Brides

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

King Janaka happily shared that his family had four wonderful princesses. So it was joyfully arranged: all four brothers would be married together! Rama would wed Sita, Lakshmana would wed Urmila, Bharata would wed Mandavi, and Shatrughna would wed Shrutakirti.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A warm, happy palace meeting hall. The two kind kings — silver-bearded **Janaka** and grey-bearded **Dasaratha** — clasp hands like old friends, smiling broadly, surrounded by their delighted families. On one side stand the four **princes** (Rama with blue tint, Lakshmana, Bharata, Shatrughna) in fine silk dhotis and gold ornaments; opposite stand four graceful **princesses** (Sita, Urmila, Mandavi, Shrutakirti) in jewel-toned bridal saris with shy, joyful expressions. Surroundings: a richly decorated hall, flower arches, hanging lamps, *rangoli* floor, attendants with garlands, soft festive light. Emotions: friendship, joy, gentle anticipation, family warmth. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft warm gradients, detailed costumes and jewelry, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic lamplight with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-turquoise-magenta-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 34: The Grand Wedding

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Mithila sparkled like a dream for the grandest wedding ever seen! Lamps glowed, drums played, and flower petals floated in the air. Four happy couples gathered, and everyone's heart was full of love and blessings.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A dazzling, festive **wedding hall at night**, glowing with hundreds of tiny oil lamps and hanging garlands. Four royal **couples** in shimmering red-and-gold bridal attire stand together radiantly; **Rama** and **Sita** at the luminous center exchange shy, loving glances, draped in jasmine and marigold garlands. Surroundings: elaborate flower-and-mango-leaf arches, a glowing sacred-fire pavilion, dancers mid-twirl, musicians with drums and *shehnai*, a joyful crowd, drifting flower petals and golden sparkles filling the warm air, soft bokeh lights beyond the arches. Emotions: love, celebration, blessing, dreamlike happiness. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous soft gradients and glowing lamplight, detailed bridal costumes and jewelry, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic night lighting with rich rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (magenta-saffron-gold-amber). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 35: Sacred Vows by the Fire

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Holding hands, each couple walked around the sacred fire and made gentle promises to love and care for one another always. Sages chanted blessings, and the gods showered flowers from above. It was a moment of pure happiness and trust.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A sacred, intimate **wedding-fire (saptapadi)** moment. **Rama** and **Sita**, hands joined and linked by a knotted ceremonial cloth (*gathbandhan*), walk slowly and solemnly around a softly glowing golden **sacred fire**, serene and devoted expressions on their faces. A white-bearded priest pours ghee offerings and chants, eyes closed; the other three couples follow behind. Above, tiny luminous **celestial beings** peek from soft glowing clouds, gently scattering flower petals down upon the couples. Surroundings: warm firelight, heaped marigolds, brass lamps and *kalash* pots, soft golden haze, a canopy of flowers. Emotions: devotion, trust, tender vows, sacred joy. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, warm glowing soft gradients, detailed ceremonial costumes, intimate atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic firelight with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-gold-rose). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 36: A Storm on the Road Home

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

As the joyful families travelled back to Ayodhya, the sky suddenly grew dark and the wind howled. Out stepped Parasurama, a fierce warrior-sage with a great axe, his eyes blazing. Everyone froze — but Rama stayed perfectly calm.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A dramatic roadside confrontation beneath a suddenly **storm-darkened sky**. The mighty warrior-sage **Parasurama** strides forward blocking the road — muscular, intense, matted jata hair, fierce blazing eyes, a huge gleaming battle-axe (**parashu**) over one shoulder and a great bow in hand, a glowing red aura, simple ascetic robes. The royal procession recoils nervously — horses rear, attendants gasp, **Dasaratha** looks alarmed — but **Rama** calmly steps forward at the front, serene and unafraid, **Lakshmana** tense at his side. Surroundings: swirling charcoal storm clouds, forks of lightning, wind-whipped banners and trees, a lonely forest road. Emotions: fierce challenge, fear, unshakable calm. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, dramatic moody gradients, glowing aura and lightning, atmospheric stormy depth with soft focus, cinematic lighting with a warm rim-glow falling on Rama; rich saturated colours (storm-grey-indigo-saffron). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 37: The Warrior's Challenge

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

"So you broke Lord Shiva's bow?" thundered Parasurama. "Let us see if you can string this mighty bow of mine!" He believed no one could match his strength. But Rama only smiled gently and accepted the challenge.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tense face-to-face standoff on the forest road. **Parasurama** holds out an enormous glowing divine **bow (the bow of Vishnu)** with a proud, challenging glare, muscles taut, axe still slung on his back, red aura flickering. **Rama** (calm, kind, quietly confident, softly glowing) steps forward to accept it with a respectful, untroubled nod and a gentle half-smile. **Lakshmana** watches protectively, one hand near his own bow; **Sita** and the family look on anxiously from chariots behind. Surroundings: dark dramatic sky beginning to part, a single hopeful sunbeam falling on Rama, wind-tossed trees, scattered leaves. Emotions: pride versus serene confidence, suspense, dawning realisation. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive

faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, moody glowing gradients, luminous divine bow, atmospheric depth with soft focus, cinematic lighting with a hopeful rim-glow on Rama; rich saturated colours (indigo-saffron-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 38: Calm Strength Wins

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

With astonishing ease, Rama lifted the great bow and bent it, ready in a heartbeat. In that moment, Parasurama understood that Rama was truly divine, and all his pride melted away. True strength, he learned, is calm and humble — never boastful.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A glowing climactic revelation. **Rama** effortlessly draws and bends **Parasurama's giant divine bow** into a full, taut arc, surrounded by a soft radiant **halo of golden light** that reveals his divine nature; his face stays gentle, calm and serene. **Parasurama** lowers his axe and bow-arm, eyes wide with humble awe and recognition, his fierce red aura softening and fading to warm gold, his proud stance melting into reverence. Surroundings: the storm clouds dramatically part to pour warm sunshine over the scene, drifting petals, returning light, the relieved family glimpsed behind. Emotions: awe, humility, peace, quiet divine majesty. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous golden soft gradients and halo, atmospheric depth with soft focus, radiant cinematic light breaking through storm with strong rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 39: Peace at Last

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Parasurama bowed respectfully to Rama and, with a peaceful heart, walked away to the quiet mountains to pray. The storm vanished and the sky turned bright and blue again. Goodness had won, gently and kindly, without any harm.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A calm, reconciled scene at warm golden hour. **Parasurama**, now peaceful and humbled, his face gentle, bows with folded hands toward **Rama** before turning to walk away along a path toward distant misty blue mountains, his axe lowered and quiet. **Rama** returns the gesture warmly with a serene smile and folded hands; **Lakshmana** relaxes beside him. Surroundings: a clear brightening sky, returning songbirds, wildflowers blooming along the roadside, soft golden light, the royal family in their chariots smiling with relief. Emotions: peace, mutual respect, relief, gentle resolution. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft warm gradients, detailed robes and landscape, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, golden-hour cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-turquoise-green-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 40: The Joyful Homecoming

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

At last the family reached Ayodhya, and the whole city burst into celebration! Streets were sprinkled with water and scattered with flowers, lamps glowed in every window, and people cheered with all their might. Their beloved princes had come home with their brides.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A grand, jubilant **homecoming to Ayodhya** at glowing sunset. The golden city overflows with celebration — flower-strewn streets sprinkled with water, glowing oil-lamps in every carved window and balcony, fluttering banners, dancing crowds, trumpeting caparisoned elephants and musicians. **King Dasaratha**, the four **princes** and their radiant **brides** ride in beautifully decorated chariots and on elephants, waving joyfully to the cheering people; **Rama** and **Sita** glow at the center. Surroundings: golden domes and temple spires, *rangoli* and *toran* archways, petals filling the air, soft sparkles of light, a warm rose-gold sky. Emotions: exuberant joy, pride, belonging, homecoming. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous warm gradients and glowing lamplight, ornate detailed architecture and costumes, festive atmospheric depth with soft focus, cinematic sunset light with rich rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-turquoise-magenta-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 41: A Warm Welcome for the Brides

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

The three loving queen-mothers welcomed Sita and the other princesses into the palace with open arms and happy tears. They performed gentle ceremonies, offered sweets, and blessed each new daughter. The royal family was now bigger, warmer, and more joyful than ever.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A heartwarming palace welcome in soft golden lamplight. The three gracious **queen-mothers** (Kaushalya, Kaikeyi, Sumitra) in elegant jewel-toned saris lovingly greet the four young **brides**, performing *aarti* with glowing brass lamp-trays, applying *tilak*, offering sweets and garlands, with tender smiles and happy tears. **Sita** stands gently at the center receiving a blessing on her forehead, eyes lowered modestly. Surroundings: a beautifully decorated palace threshold, marigold garlands, *rangoli* at the doorway, hanging lamps, trays of *laddoos* and fruit, affectionate embraces, warm golden glow. Emotions: maternal love, joy, blessing, family warmth. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, warm glowing soft gradients, detailed saris and jewelry, cozy atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic lamplight with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-rose-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 42: A Happy Beginning

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

And so Rama and Sita began their happy life together, loved by everyone for their kindness, courage, and truth. This was only the very beginning of their great adventure. For wherever there is bravery, devotion, and a good heart, a wonderful story is always waiting to unfold.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A serene, story-closing scene at peaceful golden sunset. **Rama** and **Sita** stand together happily on a high palace balcony of Ayodhya, gazing out toward a bright glowing horizon with gentle, hopeful smiles, lightly leaning toward one another; **Lakshmana**, the other brothers and their brides stand warmly nearby. Surroundings: the golden city and shimmering lotus ponds spread out below, flocks of birds crossing a warm rose-and-gold sky, soft light wrapping everyone in a tender glow, a faint first star appearing. A gentle "...and the journey has only just begun" feeling. Emotions: contentment, hope, love, the promise of more adventures. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with warm expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous soft sunset gradients, detailed costumes, sweeping atmospheric city depth with soft focus, cinematic golden-hour light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-rose-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

The End of Bala Kanda

*This completes Book One of the Ramayana — the **Bala Kanda** — retold in 42 chronological pages, faithfully preserving its core events and moral depth: the origin of Valmiki's poem, Rama's divine birth, his courage with the sage Vishwamitra, the freeing of Ahalya, the sacred legends of the descent of Ganga and the churning of the ocean, the breaking of Shiva's bow, the wedding of Rama and Sita, the humbling of Parasurama, and the joyful return to Ayodhya — woven throughout with gentle lessons of **patience, courage, compassion, humility, devotion, and keeping one's word.***

Tips for consistent illustrations:

1. Generate **Page 1 first**, then reuse its character renderings (especially Rama, Sita, Lakshmana, Vishwamitra) as a style/character reference for later pages.
2. Keep the **Master Style Block** and **Character Reference Sheet** pasted at the top of every prompt.
3. Use the same **aspect ratio (4:3)** and the "**digital children's-book illustration ... full-bleed, no border, no frame**" keywords on every page so the whole book feels like one cohesive volume.
4. To match a cover look exactly, you can switch any single page to **portrait 3:4** — the art style stays identical.